calcium or magnesium from the same food or from another source. Those foods that contain high amounts of oxalic acid usually contain sufficient calcium or magnesium to bind with all the oxalic acid in that food. Therefore, oxalic acid in these foods would not interfere with the calcium and magnesium availability of other foods in the diet. A table listing the oxalic acid content of some vegetables is available on NDL's Web site (USDA-ARS, 1984).

Sodium.—Sodium values for cooked vegetables in the database are presented separately for unsalted vegetables and for cooked vegetables with salt added. Since the sodium content of tap water varies according to location (0-39 mg/100 g), the sodium value of the cooked vegetable may be underestimated if the water supply naturally contains high amounts of sodium. It is difficult to estimate the amount of salt absorbed by vegetables during cooking. Sodium content of the cooked vegetable will depend on the amount of salt used in the cooking water and can be as high as vegetables with salt added during canning. Sodium values for cooked vegetables with added salt were calculated by adding the content from approximately 1/8 of a teaspoon of salt per 100 grams of vegetables or 236 mg of sodium to the sodium naturally occurring in the cooked vegetable with no salt added. Sodium values for canned vegetables are presented, both for product with salt added and salt not added.

Certain processing methods can cause increases in the sodium content of the vegetable or vegetable product. Some processed vegetables, such as canned, frozen, or dehydrated carrots, potatoes, sweet potatoes, and tomatoes are often lye peeled. The vegetable is dipped into a hot sodium hydroxide solution, followed by a water rinse. While the rinse will remove some of the sodium absorbed during the lye peeling operation, some will remain in the finished product.

Sodium compounds such as monosodium glutamate, disodium guanylate, and disodium inosinate may be added to some processed vegetable products as flavor enhancers. Sodium compounds may be added to potatoes to prevent browning during commercial processing. Lima beans and peas are brine sorted before blanching and freezing, which can result in the vegetables picking up sodium from the brine.

Nomenclature.— To aid in identifying individual vegetables listed in the tables, the scientific name of the vegetables is included in the food description file, usually on the raw form of the vegetable. The USDA Germplasm Resources Information Network (GRIN), (USDA, 2011) was used as the basic reference for the scientific and preferred common names. Identifying vegetables by their common names is often confusing because these names are not always applied to the same food in different geographic locations. Some names of vegetables in common use or unique to one region of the country have been indicated in the common name field of the food description file. In some cases, the usual nomenclature is particularly confusing. These are further explained in the following paragraphs.

Cassava (*Manihot esculenta*) is one of the major sources of carbohydrates for human food in many parts of the world and is also known as manioc or yuca. It is extensively

cultivated in tropical areas for its starchy, tuberous root. Cassava is sometimes called yucca, though this is a different plant. The yucca (*Yucca* spp.) is more frequently grown as an ornamental plant, though the fruits, flowers and flowering stem can be eaten. However, the root contains high levels of saponins, which are toxic.

Garden cress *(Lepidium sativum*) is a cultivated plant brought originally to this country from Europe. This plant often grows wild, and is called field cress in some areas.

Endive and chicory are often confused with each other. Cultivars of endive grown in the United States have the species name *Cichorium endivia,* and are quite different in structural appearance from Witloof chicory (*Cichonium intybus*), which is also known as French or Belgian endive. Endive (*Cichonium endivia*) is always marketed in the headed form, the larger heads weighing more than a pound. The heads are low—spreading and loose— leaved. The leaves vary from deeply cut and deeply curled in some cultivars to the broad, slightly cut and curled leaves of escarole. The outer leaves are green, and the center leaves or heart and the midribs are pale green to creamy white. Chicory is sometimes marketed as blanched heads, greens, or roots. Witloof chicory is commonly forced and can be identified by its very small, elongated, compact, well—blanched head, which resembles a small shoot and weighs about 2 ounces. Witloof chicory is also grown for greens.

The term yam is frequently used when referring to sweet potatoes in common usage and marketing. Sweet potatoes (*Ipomea batatas)* are elongated tubers with a white or orange—yellow colored flesh. The orange-yellow cultivars are commonly marketed in the United States. For the market, sweet potatoes are sometimes identified as yams. Raw, canned, and frozen sweet potatoes are sometimes identified on the label as yams. The true yam (*Dioscorea* spp.) is a tropical tuber. Yam cultivars may have white or pale—yellow flesh. In most areas of the United States, true yams are generally available only in certain specialty stores.

Raw vegetables.—Although nutrient data were available for several cultivars of some vegetables, the data base for any one cultivar was too small to justify giving separate entries by cultivar. Production data by cultivar were unavailable for most vegetables.

The values for raw potatoes listed in the tables were calculated from data for several cultivars and weighted as follows: Russet, 70 percent; White, 18 percent; and red, 12 percent.

Prepared vegetables.—Nutrient data on cooked vegetables were often unavailable or incomplete. In these cases, the appropriate nutrient values for the cooked form were calculated from the unprepared form of the same food. For example, nutrient data for cooked asparagus were calculated from data for raw asparagus. Appropriate true nutrient retention factors (NDL, 2007) were used to calculate the nutrient content of the cooked foods, after adjusting for changes in the moisture content of the uncooked foods. The same procedures were followed for the cooked, frozen vegetables.

Retention values are generally based on cooking methods that minimize the loss of nutrients, particularly the water soluble vitamins. Nutrient values of cooked vegetables obtained by these procedures tend to be higher than those values for the same vegetables cooked by less than optimum methods. Some conditions that affect the retention of nutrients in vegetables that are cooked include: Cooking method, size and shape of the vegetable or amount of surface area, maturity, condition of the vegetable, amount of cooking water, and length of cooking.

Nutrient values for vegetables prepared by microwave cooking would be similar to those obtained by conventional cooking methods, except where cooking times are lengthened because of the shape of the vegetable or the total amount of the vegetable that is cooked at one time. For example, one potato in a microwave oven will bake in approximately 5 minutes, while four potatoes will take four times longer. The ingredients and proportions used to calculate nutrient values for vegetable mixtures such as coleslaw, corn pudding, potato salad, spinach soufflé, and candied sweet potatoes are given in a footnote for each item. Values for each nutrient provided by the ingredients used in the recipe were totaled. Nutrient values were adjusted to account for any changes due to evaporation and heat destruction.

References for Notes on Foods – Vegetables and Vegetable Products

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Appendix A. Abbreviations Used in Short Descriptions

All purpose	ALLPURP
Aluminum	AL
And	&
Apple	APPL
Apples	APPLS
Applesauce	APPLSAUC
Approximate	APPROX
Approximately	APPROX
Arm and blade	ARM&BLD
Artificial	ART
Ascorbic acid	VIT C
Aspartame	ASPRT
Aspartame-sweetened	ASPRT-SWTND
Baby food	BABYFD
Baked	BKD
Barbequed	BBQ
Based	BSD
Beans	BNS
Beef	BF
Beverage	BEV
Boiled	BLD
Boneless	BNLESS
Bottled	BTLD
Bottom	BTTM
Braised	BRSD
Breakfast	BRKFST
Broiled	BRLD
Buttermilk	BTTRMLK
Calcium	CA
Calorie, calories	CAL
Canned	CND
Carbonated	CARB
Center	CNTR
Cereal	CRL
Cheese	CHS
Chicken	CHICK
Chocolate	CHOC
Choice	CHOIC
Cholesterol	CHOL
Cholesterol-free	CHOL-FREE
Chopped	CHOPD
Cinnamon	CINN

Coated	COATD
Coconut	COCNT
Commercial	COMM
Commercially	COMMLY
Commodity	CMDTY
Composite	COMP
Concentrate	CONC
Concentrated	CONCD
Condensed	COND
Condiment, condiments	CONDMNT
Cooked	CKD
Cottonseed	CTTNSD
Cream	CRM
Creamed	CRMD
Dark	DK
Decorticated	DECORT
Dehydrated	DEHYD
Dessert, desserts	DSSRT
Diluted	DIL
Domestic	DOM
Drained	DRND
Dressing	DRSNG
Drink	DRK
Drumstick	DRUMSTK
English	ENG
Enriched	ENR
Equal	EQ
Evaporated	EVAP
Except	XCPT
Extra	EX
Flank steak	FLANKSTK
Flavored	FLAV
Flour	FLR
Food	FD
Fortified	FORT
French fried	FRENCH FR
French fries	FRENCH FR
Fresh	FRSH
Frosted	FRSTD
Frosting	FRSTNG
Frozen	FRZ
Grades	GRDS
Gram	GM
Green	GRN
Greens	GRNS
Heated	HTD

Heavy	HVY
Hi-meat	HI-MT
High	HI
Hour	HR
Hydrogenated	HYDR
Imitation	IMITN
Immature	IMMAT
Imported	IMP
Include, includes	INCL
Including	INCL
Infant formula	INF FORMULA
Ingredient	ING
Instant	INST
Juice	JUC
Junior	JR
Kernels	KRNLS
Large	LRG
Lean	LN
Lean only	LN
Leavened	LVND
Light	LT
Liquid	LIQ
Low	LO
Low fat	LOFAT
Marshmallow	MARSHMLLW
Mashed	MSHD
Mayonnaise	MAYO
Medium	MED
Mesquite	MESQ
Minutes	MIN
Mixed	MXD
Moisture	MOIST
Natural	NAT
New Zealand	NZ
Noncarbonated	NONCARB
Nonfat dry milk	NFDM
Nonfat dry milk solids	NFDMS
Nonfat milk solids	NFMS
Not Further Specified	NFS
Nutrients	NUTR
Nutrition	NUTR
Ounce	OZ
Pack	PK
Par fried	PAR FR
Parboiled	PARBLD
Partial	PART

Partially	PART
Partially fried	PAR FR
Pasteurized	PAST
Peanut	PNUT
Peanuts	PNUTS
Phosphate	PO4
Phosphorus	P
Pineapple	PNAPPL
Plain	PLN
Porterhouse	PRTRHS
Potassium	K
Powder	PDR
Powdered	PDR
Precooked	PRECKD
Preheated	PREHTD
Prepared	PREP
Processed	PROC
Product code	PROD CD
Propionate	PROP
Protein	PROT
Pudding, puddings	PUDD
Ready-to-bake	RTB
Ready-to-cook	RTC
Ready-to-drink	RTD
Ready-to-eat	RTE
Ready-to-feed	RTF
Ready-to-heat	RTH
Ready-to-serve	RTS
Ready-to-use	RTU
Reconstituted	RECON
Reduced	RED
Reduced-calorie	RED-CAL
Refrigerated	REFR
Regular	REG
Reheated	REHTD
Replacement	REPLCMNT
Restaurant-prepared	REST-PREP
Retail	RTL
Roast	RST
Roasted	RSTD
Round	RND
Sandwich	SNDWCH
Sauce	SAU
Scalloped	SCALLPD
Scrambled	SCRMBLD
Seed	SD

Select	SEL
Separable[1]	
Shank and sirloin	SHK&SIRL
Short	SHRT
Shoulder	SHLDR
Simmered	SIMMRD
Skin	SKN
Small	SML
Sodium	NA
Solids	SOL
Solution	SOLN
Soybean	SOYBN
Special	SPL
Species	SP
Spread	SPRD
Standard	STD
Steamed	STMD
Stewed	STWD
Stick	STK
Sticks	STKS
Strained	STR
Substitute	SUB
Summer	SMMR
Supplement	SUPP
Sweet	SWT
Sweetened	SWTND
Sweetener	SWTNR
Teaspoon	TSP
Thousand	1000
Toasted	TSTD
Toddler	TODD
Trimmed[1]	
Trimmed to[1]	
Uncooked	UNCKD
Uncreamed	UNCRMD
Undiluted	UNDIL
Unenriched	UNENR
Unheated	UNHTD
Unprepared	UNPREP
Unspecified	UNSPEC
Unsweetened	UNSWTND
Variety, varieties	VAR
Vegetable, vegetables	VEG
Vitamin A	VIT A
Vitamin C	VIT C
Water	H20

Whitener	WHTNR
Whole	WHL
Winter	WNTR
With	W/
Without	WO/
Yellow	YEL

[1] Removed in short description